

Purnanand Samant

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Summary: Strategic operations and supply chain leader with 17+ years of experience across logistics and manufacturing. Proven expertise in Lean Six Sigma, cross-functional team leadership, and driving high-impact continuous improvement initiatives. Skilled in deploying data-driven solutions using Power BI, SQL, and Python. ASQ-certified Black Belt with a strong track record of cost savings, process optimization, and scaling digital transformation programs across complex environments. Experienced in coaching and mentoring teams on Lean practices, fostering CI culture, and leading training sessions to build organizational capability.

Skills:

Continuous Improvement: Lean Six Sigma (Black/Green Belt), DMAIC, A3, VSM, Kaizen (20+), 5S, Gemba, Standard Work

Data & Tools: Power BI, SQL, Python (ML), Minitab, AutoCAD, Visio, MS Project, GenAI Tools

Experience:

JCPenney, Reno, NV (*Sr. Manager Supply Chain Engineering*)

Aug 2022 – Apr 2025

- Led site-wide Lean initiatives and cross-functional CI programs to support strategic business goals.
- Built a real-time Power BI control tower to monitor KPIs and improve operational decision-making.
- Directed \$40M+ capital projects while implementing standardized training systems to enhance compliance and organizational readiness.
- Partnered with stakeholders across departments to resolve bottlenecks and scale solutions.
- Delivered \$1M+ in cost avoidance through structured reviews and process optimization.
- Trained and coached team members on Lean tools including VSM, 5S, A3, and Root Cause Analysis to deepen CI culture.

Petco, Reno, NV (*Lean Six Sigma Black Belt*)

Mar 2022 – Jun 2022

- Spearheaded a Data Control Tower using Power BI and SQL for real-time performance visibility.
- Facilitated Kaizens events and Lean training to accelerate CI adoption across departments.
- Mentored cross-functional teams in DMAIC methodology and Lean leadership behaviors.

Arrow Electronics, Reno, NV (*Logistics Value Add Engineer III*)

Oct 2019 – Feb 2022

- Delivered \$2M+ in savings through VSM, process redesigns, and CI program execution.
- Created Power BI and SQL-based labor forecasting and performance dashboards.
- Piloted VR-based training programs to enhance onboarding and knowledge retention.
- Partnered with stakeholders to align workflows with operational goals.
- Provided Lean coaching across teams and led CI capability- building initiatives in warehouse operations.

Arrow Electronics, Reno, NV (*Logistics Value Add Engineer II – Quality role*)

Aug 2018 – Sep 2019

- Led cross-functional CPI projects using DMAIC and A3, saving over \$1.15M.
- Reduced DPM by 70% through quality improvement initiatives.
- Built dashboards for leadership reporting and standardized documentation across facilities.
- Supported team training on problem-solving frameworks including A3 and fishbone analysis.

Arrow Electronics, Reno, NV (*Logistics Value Add Engineer II*)

Sep 2015 – Jul 2018

- Led 5S and Lean programs focused on layout redesign, cycle time, and engagement.
- Saved \$500K+ through flow optimization and standardized work deployment.
- Facilitated Kaizen events and supported performance tracking with visual management.
- Trained team leaders on Lean metrics, Gemba walk execution, and operational auditing.

Electronic Evolution Technologies, Reno, NV (Engineering Supervisor)

Dec 2013 – Sep 2015

- Led a team of 5 engineers and delivered \$300K+ in recurring value through CI projects.
- Designed Lean layouts using AutoCAD and Visio, improving flow and team collaboration.
- Aligned engineering activities with business goals and progress tracking.
- Mentored engineers in Lean tools and guided team development through hands-on coaching.

Electronic Evolution Technologies, Reno, NV (Manufacturing/ Process Engineer)

Jul 2011 – Nov 2015

- Implemented layout improvements that saved \$100K annually.
- Delivered Standardized work procedures and coordinated cross-functional production support.
- Collaborated with teams to identify improvement areas and shared Lean best practices.

Smart Electronics and Assembly, Anaheim, CA (Manufacturing/ Process Engineer)

Jan 2008 – Jun 2011

- Reduced labor costs by 70% and lead time by 50% using lean and TOC principles.
- Applied DMAIC to develop scalable, repeatable production processes.
- Conducted time studies and resource modeling to align staffing with demand.

Hidden Valley Electronics, Binghamton, NY (Research Intern)

Jan 2006 – Aug 2007

- Built predictive models with Minitab and SAS, reducing cycle time by 20%.
- Conducted comparative analysis for tooling improvements and process optimization.
- Applied statistical methods to solve real-world production challenges.

Publications:

- “Application of Artificial Neural Networks to predict defect levels in wave soldering process” 13th Annual International conference on Industrial Engineering, September 2008

Education:**MS in Industrial Engineering** - SUNY Binghamton**BS in Mechanical Engineering** - University of Mumbai**Certifications:**

ASQ Six Sigma Black Belt | ASQ Six Sigma Green Belt | Lean Manufacturing
Machine Learning Specialization (DeepLearning.AI)
SQL Beginner to Advanced for Data Professionals (Codebasics)
Electronics Packaging